

Suunngitsumik ulapiissutiginnineq

(Kalaallisut ¹ for "Much Ado About Nothing")

(January 2026)

It is quite curious that everybody and their cousin comment on the U.S. president's lust for Greenland and on an imminent purchase from Denmark, which most claim is unavoidable. It seems that not many, if any, pay much attention to the fact that Greenland is an autonomous, self-governed entity, on its way to full independence since at least half a century ago.

The country enjoys one of the highest GDP per capita in the world, and only about 6% of its inhabitants expressed an approval of U.S. occupation, while all political parties strongly oppose it. A much heralded "sale" by Denmark is therefore rather awkward legally, and a military invasion would represent a 21st century colonization of a population consisting mostly of Inuit stock, one of the major Native American Nations. Would Greenland become the United States' one and only (and by far the most extensive) reservation under full dominion of the U.S. while Native American reservations in the U.S. enjoy quasi-sovereignty? Are we back to ancient 19th century colonial times, a novel Scramble for Arctica, although two centuries late?

Sober reality is rather that Denmark would not be legally able to sell Greenland, since Denmark does not own Greenland. Short of that the next

¹ Kalaallisut is the sole official language of Kalaallit Nunaat (a.k.a. Greenland in English)

alternative could perhaps be for the modern U.S. geopolitical luminaries to bribe the Inuit Nation, but, with such a high Human Development Index as the island's, it is highly unlikely that its inhabitants will be willing to trade current Danish subsidies of \$12,000 per year per capita, plus free healthcare, including emergencies in Copenhagen's best hospitals and transportation thereat, as well as free university education, for a one time pittance. It is perhaps worthwhile remembering that the U.S. is not particularly renowned for its free healthcare benefits or free college education.

So the U.S. would have to invade and colonize by force, much like Western nations did before World War II everywhere in the world, at the cost of a massive international backlash and, more farcically, a probable reversal with apologies and a hundred billion dollars in reparations after the next U.S. presidential elections. Also, the claim that China and Russia are fiercely determined to colonize Greenland is perhaps a bit foolhardy, especially at a time when both are doing their very best to secure the respect and alliance of the Western colonial empires of lore, and certainly lack both taste and wherewithal for such a frivolous undertaking. As for the U.S. general staff, it is said to be exceedingly reluctant to engage in such an illegal neocolonial adventure.

With regard to the neighborly aspect, a glimpse at the map would suggest that half of Greenland is closer to Denmark than to the U.S., while its distance to the northernmost point in the U.S. is about the same as that from Mar-a-Lago to somewhere between Venezuela and Brazil. Not exactly a neighbor.

It is quite mystifying that most commentators should describe the annexation as a done deal, and claim, or lament, that Denmark won't have much choice, missing the point that it is not Denmark's prerogative to sell but Greenland's.

Colonization of Greenland would certainly trigger an avalanche of lawsuits and protests around the globe for strictly no benefit other than the narcissistic pride of a few politicians, since the U.S. already commands by treaty since the 1940s all the military presence it could wish on the island, and reversal would be quite guaranteed when some new candidate ascends to the presidency, with apologies and a hundred billion dollar reparations package.

In the words of the Bard: "Much Ado About Nothing"